



Humanitarian Assistance Information Centre

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Steering Committee, Humanitarian Assistance Information Centre
Nairobi 15 May 2001
UNDP Somalia Conference Room, Centenary House, Westlands off Ring Road

REVISED DRAFT

PARTICIPANTS

See attached list

The meeting was co-chaired by Mr. Foresman and Mr. Kent.

OPENING

The meeting was opened by Mr. Forseman who welcomed all and expressed appreciation at the continuing interest in the initiative. It was proposed that in future a smaller committee may be more practical and focussed. The agenda was adopted.

AGENDA

1. Update
2. Review and discussion of the Project Proposal
3. Institutional framework (hosting agency and implementing agency)
4. Review of name for the initiative
5. Fundraising strategy
6. Next steps

DISCUSSION

Update

Mr. Sartori briefed the meeting on the status of work undertaken by UNDP Somalia Data and Information Management Unit with the assistance of Mr. Alspach (UNHCR/ HAIC). He previewed the website [Horn of Africa Data.org](http://Horn_of_Africa_Data.org) showing proposed links and a sample of meta data. He emphasised the need for standards for data collection to be adopted early on. The International Working Group on Cartography is developing standards in this area which could be utilised. DIMU has been working with participants and contributors on a voluntary basis. This now needs to be coordinated within an institutional framework.

Review and discussion of the Project Proposal

The proposal will be redrafted taking into consideration comments received and concerns expressed by the participants. Written comments received were distributed. A working group composed of Mr. Alinovi (FAO), Mr. Bakkun (UNDP), Mr. Alspach

(UNHCR), Mr. Kofoed (UNEP) and Mr. Sartori (UNDP) volunteered to prepare a first revision in conjunction with Mr. Watkins (OCHA) by the beginning of the coming week.

Information is owned by and falls within the legal framework of individual governments. The roles, responsibilities, sensitivities and reciprocity involved in working with governments were agreed to be areas requiring careful forward planning. Suggestions for liaising with and involving governments and their respective departments will be addressed during the proposal revision process. Provision for linkage and cooperation with IGAD will be included in the proposal.

Institutional framework

Strong points of view were expressed on this topic. FAO supported a highly structured institutional system. The organisation has much data it is willing to contribute to a well-structured and efficient system. UNEP supported a practical approach with common stored data for everyone. He suggested the initiative be viewed as a product unencumbered by bricks and mortar. It was agreed by all that specific expectations of the initiative must be crystal clear with a mandate to produce data and make it freely available.

Candidates for hosting agency and implementing agency were discussed. OCHA expressed a strong interest. After discussion it was agreed by all the participants that UNEP will be the hosting agency and UNOPS will be the implementing agency.

Review of name for the initiative

The name of the initiative will largely follow on from the institutional framework adopted. Application and facility were suggested for inclusion. Beware offending acronyms!

Fundraising strategy

Following endorsement, the revised proposal will be submitted to donors. To avoid duplication of services it will be necessary to ascertain if similar initiatives are current or proposed by other bodies such as the IGAD initiative, RIIS. Mr. Foresman was willing to take the document to New York to attract funding he believes is imminently available. This necessitates prompt action on the proposal revision. A copy of the United Nations Geographic Database Proposal will be distributed to all participants.

Next steps – listed below as action points.

ACTION POINTS

1. Proposal to be redrafted to incorporate points discussed at this meeting. Small group to convene and complete draft for distribution to all participants on Friday 18th May. Comments and suggestions to be submitted on Monday 21st May.
2. Name of initiative – Mr. Sartori to contact individuals, collect suggestions. List of three options to be distributed.
3. Establish an Executive committee/ board. Selection criteria to be considered include context, development, humanitarian, contribution/ involvement, availability.

Meeting closed at 4.35pm.